

Maitri Dolls - Latest Approach Summary

For today's discussion with Shwethika | 17 June 2026

Core refinement

Maitri should stay focused before it scales. The first launch should not try to sell the entire ecosystem at once. The immediate job is to make parents feel the doll is educational and meaningful, and make children fall in love with Manu as a character.

First product direction

In every first box	Doll, 32-page storybook, letter from Manu, six activity pages, and sticker pages.
Story anchor	Book 1 should focus on one childhood period: Manu: The Horse Nobody Could Ride. It ends before she becomes queen so children relate to her as a child.
Why this matters	The doll creates the object of play. The story creates the relationship. The letter makes Manu feel like a friend. Activities and stickers create repeat engagement.

Manu story arc

- Act 1: Manu feels different and asks why girls cannot learn and explore like boys.
- Act 2: A difficult horse arrives. Manu notices fear where others only see stubbornness.
- Act 3: The horse may be sold away. Manu asks for one chance and chooses patience before control.
- Act 4: Manu earns trust through courage and care. The ending points toward her future without rushing into it.

Business architecture

The first box should feel complete, but the revenue model should expand separately. Small add-ons can include sticker packs, journals, flash cards, simple dress or hair sets. Later playsets can include Badal, a warrior kit, and eventually a Jhansi Fort or Build a Kingdom map game.

What has been structured now

- A clearer repo foundation: strategy, product development, character universe, content, validation, source context, and ChatGPT setup.
- A ChatGPT Business structure with four Projects: Maitri HQ, Manu First Box, Content Studio, and Validation and Signals.
- Two active agents to start: Maitri Chief of Staff and Maitri Content Producer.
- A refreshed website direction: story-first, warm, parent-trusted, and centered on Manu as the first character anchor.

Call focus

- Confirm the first-box scope and age band.
- Decide how Manu's storybook should feel: storybook-first, activity-led, or premium keepsake.
- Review website refinements against the new approach.
- Agree what must be validated before any preorder or larger product expansion.

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